

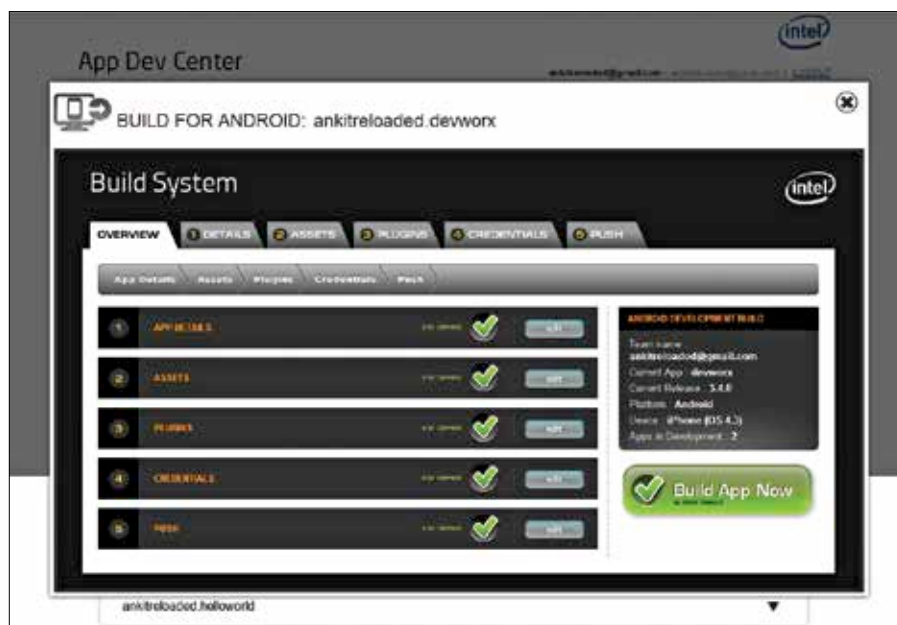
project files, so that the code can be directly run into a Windows Phone 8 emulator. Other listed hardware requirements are a minimum of 4GB RAM and at least 200MB hard disk space, though I don't believe the tool exactly checks for those and will run fine if you have a slightly lesser configuration. The App Porter Tool is currently in Beta and can be downloaded from Intel's website at software.intel.com/en-us/html5.

GETTING STARTED

The tool currently takes in the path of the XCode project file of your application and produces the output in the form of translated HTML5, Javascript and CSS code. Any untranslated methods or code are marked into empty placeholder files which can be manually implemented by the developer at a later point in time. It currently produces code that uses the standard HTML5 API and the JQuery Mobile library. There is also a custom App Porter library that is used for functionality which is otherwise not available in standard tools.

As an example, you can take up any demo application from its iOS code and try running it through the tool. The sample application from the HTML5 App Porter tutorial available online on Intel's website also fits our purpose perfectly as it includes all components including XIB files and is fairly complex enough to check the functionality of the tool. The first step involves providing the path for the XCode project file for the application and specifying the output folder where the HTML5 files are to be stored. The following screen lets you choose the modules you want to be translated into HTML5 and possibly define any additional include directories and pre-processor definitions. It goes without saying that you should not choose any module that is known to cause problems in translation, or is better to be coded directly into Javascript.

After the module parsing, XIB processing and API coverage analysis is complete, you will be asked to see the API translation report and unselect any methods that are not properly translated. This will finally end in all the API calls being translated to HTML5 and Javascript, which will be followed by a translation report along with a API call which could not be translated, in the form of TODO files. You should also be able to see statistics related to the translation and the number of views converted from XIB to HTML and CSS. Here you can open the application in the emulator



The Android Build Screen



The Intel HTML5 Playground

and check the functionality of the application. If you do not have Visual Studio 2012 installed you will see a warning making you aware of the same fact and you will be able to open the files in the file explorer.

This whole process is followed by making sure that all the components translated by the tool are working properly without any errors and implementing any functionality which is needed in the final application.

HTML5 PLAYGROUND

Intel's HTML5 playground tool is a simple developer tool to see real time output of HTML5 code right inside the browser window. It is a sort of sandbox environment which allows you to check the functionality of snippets of code and also has some nifty code examples up its sleeve. If you want, you can

also share the link to your code to demonstrate the functionality to your friends, giving it a social perspective.

These are some of the tools which are a part of Intel's kitty of tools available for HTML5 and which provide a good enough functionality for anyone to jump into app development. Getting started with most of these tools is a no brainer and almost all of them have a much lower entry barrier for beginners as opposed to native applications. The readymade templates for some of the HTML5 apps just might promote anyone to get started with app development and create an app with minor help available from the forums and documentation. The best part is, since most of all the tools support hybrid functionality, monetization is not much of a problem as opposed to other apps on the open web. ■